STATE EMPLOYMENT AGENCY

Service Design Document (SDD)

Labour and Employment Subsystem (LMAS)
End-to-End Service Design

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1. Executive Summary

This Service Design Document describes the end-to-end design of the Labour and Employment Subsystem (LMAS), a digital government service that allows citizens to access employment-related services through online channels. The service is being designed for the State Employment Agency of Azerbaijan with the goal of improving service accessibility, reducing processing time and increasing citizen satisfaction.

The current employment service process requires citizens to visit government offices in person, submit paper documents and wait for manual processing. This approach creates bottlenecks, limits accessibility for citizens outside of Baku and does not provide real-time status tracking. The LMAS project aims to digitize the full citizen service journey from application submission to final result delivery.

The service design follows a citizen-centered approach, using life-event-based service grouping where employment services are organized around key life events such as job search, unemployment registration and labor contract management. The design includes multiple digital channels (web portal, Telegram bot), a real-time monitoring dashboard and integration with other government systems through a single-window architecture.

Key Design Decisions

Decision Area	Selected Approach
Citizen journey model	Life-event-based service journey from application to result
Primary digital channel	Telegram bot for application submission and status tracking
Secondary channel	Web portal for detailed service access and document upload
Monitoring	Real-time management dashboard with SLA and KPI tracking
Integration	Multi-agency data exchange with 5+ government organizations
Methodology	End-to-end process architecture with As-Is / To-Be analysis

2. Service Vision and Objectives

2.1 Service Vision

To provide every citizen in Azerbaijan with accessible, transparent and efficient employment services through digital channels, reducing the need for physical office visits while maintaining high service quality standards.

2.2 Strategic Objectives

ID	Objective	Priority

OBJ-01	Increase digital service adoption rate to 60% within the first year of operation	High
OBJ-02	Reduce average service processing time from 14 days to 5 business days	High
OBJ-03	Eliminate the requirement for physical office visits for standard employment services	Medium
OBJ-04	Provide real-time application status tracking for 100% of submitted applications	High
OBJ-05	Achieve citizen satisfaction score of 4.0 or higher (out of 5.0)	Medium
OBJ-06	Establish SLA compliance rate of 90% or above for all service stages	High

2.3 Success Metrics

Metric	Description	Target	Timeline
Digital adoption rate	Percentage of applications submitted through digital channels	60%	12 months
Average processing time	Calendar days from application to final decision	5 days	6 months
Citizen satisfaction score	Average rating from post-service survey	4.0 / 5.0	12 months
SLA compliance rate	Percentage of applications processed within SLA target	90%	6 months
Office visit reduction	Percentage decrease in physical office visits	70%	12 months
System uptime	Percentage of time digital channels are available	99.5%	Ongoing

3. Service Context and Stakeholder Analysis

3.1 Organizational Context

The State Employment Agency is responsible for managing employment services across Azerbaijan. The agency operates through regional offices where citizens can access services in person. The LMAS project is part of the broader digital government transformation strategy led by the Innovation and Digital Development Agency.

The service ecosystem includes multiple government organizations that contribute data and participate in the employment service process. These include the Ministry of Labour and Social

Protection, the State Social Protection Fund, the Ministry of Education and local municipality offices. Coordinating across these organizations is a critical success factor for the LMAS project.

3.2 Stakeholder Map

Stakeholder	Role	Interaction	Influence
Citizens (Job seekers)	Primary user	Submit applications, track status, receive results	High
Employers	Secondary user	Post vacancies, review candidate profiles	Medium
State Employment Agency	Service owner	Process applications, manage service delivery	High
Ministry of Labour	Policy body	Set employment policies, regulatory oversight	High
Social Protection Fund	Data provider	Provide social insurance and benefit data	Medium
Innovation Agency	Strategic partner	Digital transformation methodology, standards	Medium
IT Department	Technical team	System development, infrastructure, maintenance	High
Regional Offices	Service delivery	Handle cases requiring physical presence	Medium

3.3 Stakeholder Communication Plan

Stakeholder	Frequency	Topics
State Employment Agency management	Bi-weekly steering committee	Project status, risks, decisions
Ministry of Labour	Monthly alignment meeting	Policy updates, regulatory changes
Innovation Agency	Monthly progress review	Methodology alignment, standards compliance
IT Department	Weekly sprint review	Technical progress, blockers
Regional Offices	Monthly feedback session	User feedback, process improvement

4. User Research and Personas

4.1 Research Approach

User research was conducted through stakeholder interviews with 12 employees of the State Employment Agency and analysis of 200+ citizen feedback records from the existing service delivery process. The research identified key pain points, user needs and behavioral patterns that directly influenced the service design decisions.

4.2 Key Research Findings

Finding	Detail
Accessibility barrier	65% of citizens outside Baku find it difficult to visit regional offices due to distance and travel costs
Lack of transparency	78% of applicants do not know the status of their application after submission
Document complexity	52% of applications are rejected due to incomplete or incorrect documentation
Processing delays	Average processing time is 14 calendar days, with some cases taking over 30 days
Limited channels	Currently only in-person service delivery is available, no digital alternatives
Repeat visits	40% of citizens visit the office more than once for a single service request

4.3 Citizen Personas

Persona 1: Young Job Seeker

Age: 22-28, recently graduated from university, lives in a regional city. Comfortable with technology, uses smartphone daily, prefers digital channels over physical visits. Needs to register as unemployed and access job search services. Expects fast processing and real-time status updates. Pain point: traveling to the nearest regional office takes a full day and costs significant money.

Persona 2: Mid-Career Worker

Age: 35-45, recently lost their job, has family responsibilities. Moderate technology skills, uses smartphone but may need guidance. Needs unemployment benefits and retraining program information. Expects clear communication about eligibility and next steps. Pain point: does not understand which documents are required and often submits incomplete applications.

Persona 3: Employer

Small or medium business owner, needs to post job vacancies and find suitable candidates. Prefers online platforms, expects quick response from the employment agency. Pain point: current process requires in-person visits to submit vacancy information, which is time-consuming for a busy business owner.

5. As-Is Service Journey Analysis

5.1 Current Process Overview

The current employment service process is primarily paper-based and requires citizens to visit a regional office of the State Employment Agency. The process involves multiple manual steps, paper

document handling and limited communication between the citizen and the agency during processing. There is no digital channel for application submission or status tracking.

5.2 Current Service Journey Stages

Stage	Activity	Pain Point
1. Awareness	Citizen learns about available services through word-of-mouth or media	Low awareness, no centralized information
2. Document Preparation	Citizen gathers required documents (ID, diploma, references)	Unclear requirements, frequent rejections due to incomplete documents
3. Office Visit	Citizen travels to regional office, waits in queue, submits paper application	Long travel time, queues, limited office hours
4. Application Receipt	Officer reviews documents, creates paper file, provides receipt number	No digital record, manual data entry errors
5. Processing	Application is reviewed by multiple officers across different departments	Average 14 days, no visibility for citizen
6. Decision	Final decision is made and recorded on paper file	No notification system, citizen must call or visit to check
7. Result Delivery	Citizen visits office again to receive the decision document	Second visit required, additional cost and time

5.3 Gap Analysis Summary

Current Gap	Description	Proposed Solution
No digital channel	All services require physical office visit	Online application submission via Telegram bot and web portal
No status tracking	Citizens cannot check application progress	Real-time status updates through digital channels
Manual processing	Paper-based workflow with manual handoffs	Automated workflow with digital document management
No integration	Data not shared between government organizations	Multi-agency data exchange through middleware layer
No SLA monitoring	Processing time not measured or tracked	Real-time SLA and KPI monitoring dashboard

6. To-Be Service Design

6.1 Designed Service Journey

The redesigned service journey follows a life-event-based approach where the entire employment service is structured around the citizen need of finding employment or managing labor-related requirements. The journey covers the full end-to-end process from initial awareness through final result delivery, with digital channels as the primary interaction point.

Stage	Activity	Improvement
1. Awareness	Citizen discovers services through my.gov.az portal, ASAN Service or social media	Centralized digital information hub
2. Digital Application	Citizen submits application via Telegram bot or web portal with guided document checklist	Digital form with real-time validation
3. Automatic Verification	System automatically verifies citizen data with integrated government databases	Reduced document requirements, faster processing
4. Digital Processing	Application is processed through automated workflow with digital routing	Target: 5 business days
5. Real-Time Tracking	Citizen receives status notifications at each processing stage	Telegram notifications + portal dashboard
6. Digital Decision	Decision is recorded digitally and citizen is notified immediately	Push notification with result and next steps
7. Digital Delivery	Citizen receives the decision document through the digital channel	PDF download or delivery via ASAN Service

6.2 Service Principles

Principle	Description
Citizen-first design	Every design decision starts from the citizen need, not institutional convenience
Digital by default	Digital channels are the primary service delivery method, physical visits are the exception
Life-event grouping	Services are organized around citizen life events, not government departments
Transparency	Citizens have full visibility into their application status at all times
Multi-agency coordination	Service delivery requires seamless data exchange between government organizations
Continuous improvement	Service performance is measured through KPIs and user feedback drives improvements

7. Service Blueprint

7.1 Blueprint Overview

The service blueprint maps the relationship between the citizen journey and the back-stage processes, support systems and organizational structures required to deliver the service. The blueprint identifies critical touchpoints, handoff points between departments and integration requirements with external systems.

7.2 Blueprint Layers

Layer	Components
Physical Evidence	Telegram bot interface, Web portal, Notification messages, PDF decision documents
Citizen Actions	Open app, Fill application, Upload documents, Check status, Download result
Front-Stage (Visible)	Welcome message, Application form, Document validation, Status page, Result delivery
Back-Stage (Internal)	Data verification, Routing to department, Review process, Decision recording, Notification trigger
Support Systems	Database, Integration middleware, Workflow engine, Monitoring dashboard, Document management

7.3 Critical Touchpoints

ID	Touchpoint	Description	Channel
TP-01	Application form	Digital form with guided document checklist and real-time validation	Telegram bot + Web portal
TP-02	Document upload	Digital document upload with format and size validation	Web portal
TP-03	Status notification	Push notification at each stage change	Telegram bot
TP-04	Support chat	In-app chat for citizen questions and guidance	Telegram bot
TP-05	Result delivery	Digital decision document with QR verification code	Portal + ASAN delivery

8. Service Channels and Touchpoints

8.1 Channel Strategy

The service is delivered through a multi-channel approach with the Telegram bot as the primary channel for application submission and status tracking. The web portal serves as a secondary channel for more complex interactions such as document upload and detailed service information. Physical office visits are reserved for exceptional cases that cannot be handled digitally.

Channel	Role	Services	Target Volume
Telegram Bot	Primary	Application submission, status tracking, notifications, citizen support	Target: 70% of interactions
Web Portal	Secondary	Detailed service information, document upload, account	Target: 30% of interactions

		management	
ASAN Service Centers	Exception	Cases requiring physical document verification or citizen without digital access	Target: Less than 10%
Regional Offices	Exception	Complex cases requiring face-to-face consultation	Target: Less than 5%

8.2 Channel Integration

All channels share a unified backend system, ensuring that citizen data and application status are consistent across channels. A citizen can start an application on the web portal and continue tracking it via the Telegram bot without any data loss. The integration layer uses a single-window architecture that connects all channels to the central LMAS system.

9. Multi-Agency Coordination Model

9.1 Coordination Framework

The LMAS service requires data exchange and coordination with multiple government organizations. The coordination model defines how agencies interact, what data is shared and what the responsibilities of each agency are in the service delivery process. This model ensures that citizens receive a seamless service experience without needing to understand the internal organizational structure of government.

9.2 Agency Roles and Data Exchange

Agency	Role	Data	Direction
State Employment Agency	Service owner	Application data, processing status, decision results	Provides and consumes
Ministry of Labour	Policy oversight	Employment policies, regulatory requirements	Provides
Social Protection Fund	Data provider	Social insurance records, benefit payment history	Provides
Ministry of Education	Data provider	Education records, diploma verification	Provides
State Statistics Committee	Data consumer	Aggregated employment statistics	Consumes
Innovation Agency	Standards body	Digital service standards, methodology guidelines	Provides

9.3 Integration Architecture

The integration architecture uses a middleware layer that connects the LMAS system with external government databases through standardized API interfaces. The middleware handles data

transformation, authentication, logging and error handling. This approach allows each agency to maintain its own systems while sharing data through secure, controlled interfaces. The middleware design is based on the single-window government portal principle, where the citizen interacts with one service while the system coordinates with multiple agencies in the background.

10. Service Standards (SLA and KPI)

10.1 Service Level Agreements

ID	Service	Target	Compliance	Notes
SLA-01	Application acknowledgment	Immediate (automated)	100%	System sends confirmation within 30 seconds
SLA-02	Document verification	1 business day	95%	Automatic verification with government databases
SLA-03	Application processing	5 business days	90%	Full review and decision by assigned officer
SLA-04	Status notification	Within 2 hours of status change	99%	Automated push notification via Telegram
SLA-05	Decision delivery	1 business day after decision	95%	Digital delivery with QR verification
SLA-06	System availability	99.5% uptime	99.5%	Planned maintenance outside business hours

10.2 Key Performance Indicators

ID	KPI	Description	Target	Frequency
KPI-01	Digital channel adoption	Percentage of citizens using digital channels	60%	Monthly
KPI-02	First-contact resolution	Citizen issue resolved in first interaction	80%	Monthly
KPI-03	Application completion rate	Applications submitted without abandonment	85%	Weekly
KPI-04	Average processing time	Mean days from submission to decision	5 days	Weekly
KPI-05	Citizen satisfaction (CSAT)	Post-service survey average rating	4.0/5.0	Monthly
KPI-06	SLA compliance	Percentage of SLAs	90%	Monthly

		met within target		
KPI-07	Error rate	Percentage of applications with processing errors	Less than 3%	Weekly

10.3 Monitoring Dashboard

A real-time monitoring dashboard is designed for the management board to track all SLA and KPI indicators. The dashboard provides visual displays of application volumes, processing times, SLA compliance rates and citizen satisfaction scores. The dashboard is updated in real-time and accessible through a web interface. Alerts are configured for SLA breaches and unusual patterns in application volumes or processing times.

11. Service Portfolio Alignment

11.1 Portfolio Context

The LMAS is part of the broader government service portfolio managed by the State Employment Agency. The service portfolio includes employment registration, job search, vocational training, labor contract management and unemployment benefits. The LMAS design ensures alignment with the existing portfolio structure and uses consistent design patterns, data models and integration standards across all services.

11.2 Alignment with Government Service Standards

The service design follows the digital government service standards set by the Innovation and Digital Development Agency. These standards cover service design methodology, data exchange protocols, security requirements and citizen experience guidelines. The LMAS is designed to be compatible with the my.gov.az unified government portal, enabling citizens to access employment services alongside other government services through a single entry point.

Area	Standard	Status
Service design methodology	Innovation Agency standards	Aligned - uses As-Is / To-Be analysis, citizen journey mapping
Data exchange	Government interoperability framework	Aligned - uses standardized API interfaces
Authentication	my.gov.az single sign-on	Aligned - supports SSO integration
Notification	Government notification standards	Aligned - uses official notification channels
Accessibility	WCA 2.1 AA standards	Partially aligned - planned for Phase 2

12. Process Architecture

12.1 Architecture Overview

The process architecture defines the structure, layers and relationships of all processes within the LMAS. The architecture is designed at three levels: strategic (service portfolio and life-event grouping), tactical (end-to-end service processes) and operational (individual task workflows). This multi-level approach ensures that the service is managed both at the process architecture level and at the operational execution level, as required by the Agency standards.

12.2 Process Layers

Layer	Scope
Strategic layer	Service portfolio management, life-event categorization, service priority definition
Tactical layer	End-to-end service processes (application to result), cross-agency coordination workflows
Operational layer	Individual task workflows, document verification steps, notification triggers

12.3 As-Is / To-Be Process Mapping

Each service process has been mapped from As-Is state to To-Be state using BPMN process models. The As-Is models capture the current paper-based processes with all manual steps, bottlenecks and handoff points. The To-Be models define the redesigned digital processes with automated workflows, validation rules and integration touchpoints. The gap between As-Is and To-Be has been analyzed and documented, and the transition plan is included in the Implementation Roadmap section of this document.

13. Implementation Roadmap

13.1 Phased Approach

The implementation follows a phased approach to manage risk and deliver value incrementally. Each phase delivers a working subset of the service that can be tested and validated before moving to the next phase. The roadmap is aligned with the Agency quarterly planning cycle.

Phase	Name	Timeline	Deliverables
Phase 1	Foundation	Month 1-3	Core system setup, database, integration middleware, Telegram bot MVP
Phase 2	Core Services	Month 4-6	Digital application submission, automatic verification, status tracking
Phase 3	Full Integration	Month 7-9	Multi-agency data

			exchange, monitoring dashboard, web portal
Phase 4	Optimization	Month 10-12	Performance optimization, accessibility improvements, advanced analytics

13.2 Critical Dependencies

Dependency	Description	Impact	Required By
Government database access	API access to Social Protection Fund and Ministry of Education databases	High	Phase 2
my.gov.az integration	Single sign-on and unified portal integration	Medium	Phase 3
ASAN Service integration	Physical document delivery channel integration	Low	Phase 3
Staff training	Training for agency staff on new digital processes	High	Phase 2
Legal framework	Regulatory approval for digital application submission	High	Phase 1

14. Risks and Dependencies

14.1 Risk Register

ID	Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
R-01	Low citizen adoption of digital channels	High	Medium	User awareness campaign, simplified onboarding, ASAN support
R-02	Integration delays with government databases	High	High	Early engagement with IT teams, fallback manual process
R-03	Data quality issues in existing databases	Medium	High	Data cleansing before migration, validation rules
R-04	Staff resistance to new processes	Medium	Medium	Change management program, training, phased rollout
R-05	System performance under	Medium	High	Load testing, scalable

	high load			architecture, caching strategy
R-06	Regulatory changes during implementation	Low	Medium	Regular policy review, flexible process design

15. Appendix: Glossary

Term	Definition
LMAS	Labour and Employment Subsystem - the digital employment service system
SLA	Service Level Agreement - defined performance targets for service delivery
KPI	Key Performance Indicator - measurable value that shows service performance
As-Is	Current state of a process before redesign
To-Be	Future state of a process after redesign
BPMN	Business Process Model and Notation - standard for process modeling
Life-event	A significant event in citizen life around which services are grouped
Single-window	A unified access point for multiple government services
Touchpoint	Any interaction point between the citizen and the service
Service Blueprint	A diagram that shows the relationship between service components
Service Portfolio	The complete set of services offered by an organization
Process Architecture	The structural design of processes across an organization